

What dreams do people give up on because they drift down the standard path through life? How many people don't start their business because they're afraid they will fail? How many people don't take that trip of a lifetime because they can't afford it or can't get vacation time approved? How many marriages start filled with hope, promise, and romance only to crumble under the strain of financial stress and time demands that burden so many?

When you *Choose FI*, you are choosing a way of life with more options and less fear. You're choosing to live life in alignment with your values. FI provides freedom. It's easy to see why choosing FI is appealing. So why do so few people do it? Why do so many fail to diverge from the standard path despite its limitations? One reason is simply the fact that the standard path is . . . the standard. It's the norm. The standard path is deeply ingrained by schools, families, media, and popular culture. Above all else, most people have never thought that there might be a different way. We all know people on the standard path. We have all probably been on that path as well. It's a challenge to take a different path without anyone to guide you.

Author and motivational speaker Jim Rohn frequently said, "You are the average of the five people you spend the most time with." The examples in this book and the people you'll meet in the FI